

Week one started with basics of web development. We learned about:

- Git and Github basics
- Basic HTML
- Semantics of HTML
- Div containers, lists, input methods, buttons etc.
- CSS Styling
- Box model, margins, paddings, border, etc
- Flexbox, grids

The work started by learning html from scratch, even when I had some prior knowledge to it, I started again from basics and gained a proper structured knowledge of it. From the resources, I also made a mini html project which strengthened my understanding of it.

I then moved to learning CSS. Understanding the main logic of it was easy. Box model was the first topic that took me time to understand and visualize well. During my learning, I strategically focused on topics that were more relevant to the given task and the project, instead of trying to cram up all the information from the resources.

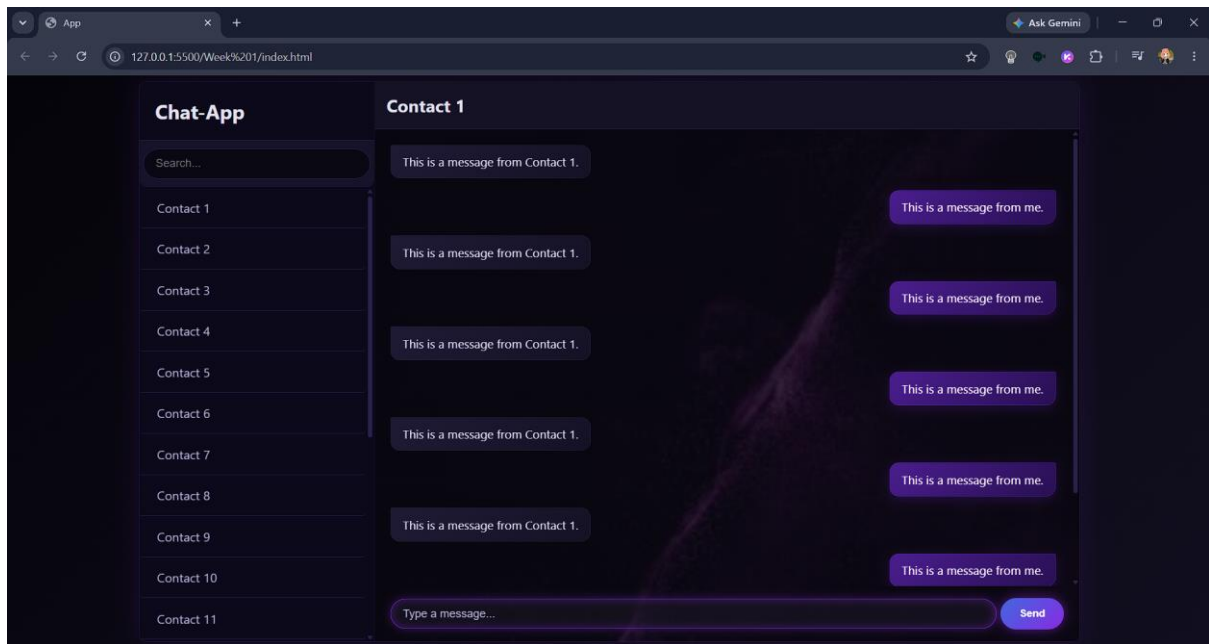
For that, I focused more on learning about flex boxes, because it was one of the major elements in the chat app UI we had to during this week. The app container, sidebar, contacts list, chat area, were all flex boxes.

For the task, we had to make a mock UI for the chat app using vanilla HTML and CSS. I first made an HTML base, and used div elements everywhere I could for better customization when using CSS. And also focused on writing proper class-names for elements so as to not get confused during CSS. I kept a dark-cosmic theme for the UI. These are the major highlights about it:

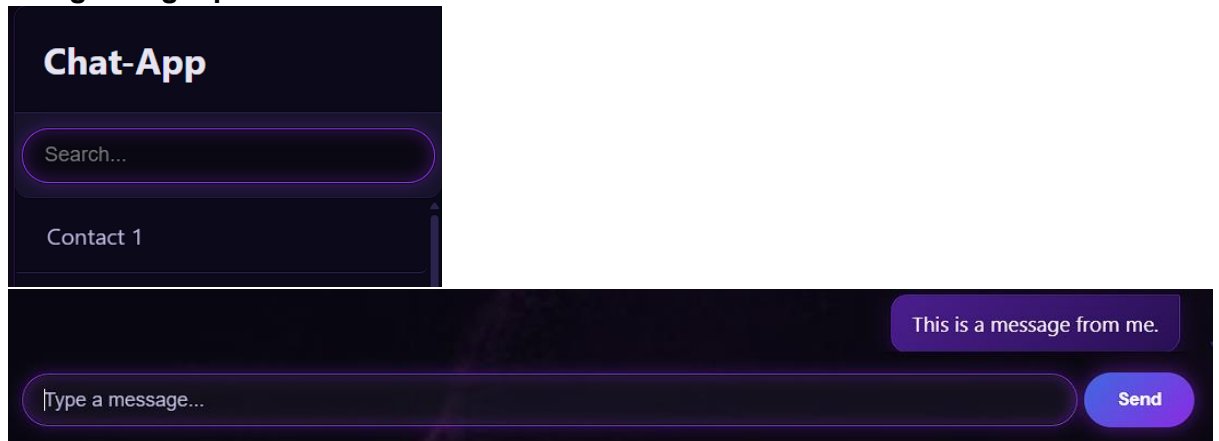
1. Side Bar
 - a. On top is the app name header
 - b. Below it is the search bar. Has a purple glow when you click on it to type.
 - c. Below that is the contacts list. Overall design is kept minimalistic. Has a hover effect when you hover over any contact. Overflow is enabled so that whole app doesn't expand when contacts exceed visible area.
 - d. Has a sleek side bar to scroll through contacts
2. Chat Area
 - a. On top is header showing the contact name
 - b. Has wide message area with message bubbles, coloured differently for received and sent messages.
 - c. The input also has a purple glow effect when focused on, with a send button just right to it.

Also added media query for devices with smaller screens. The sidebar is hidden completely and chat area takes the whole space.

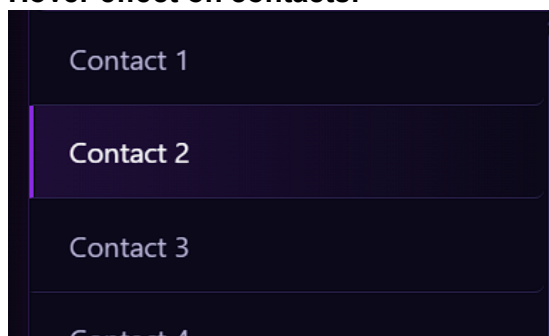
The Base UI:



The glowing input bars:



Hover effect on contacts:



One challenge I faced while learning was being able to track all the CSS options. It was later that I understood to focus more on the logic, and core understanding of it. And then would later use resources to go through certain syntax when required saving time.